

Industrial relations are the **relationships between employees and employers within the organizational settings.**

The field of industrial relations looks at the relationship between management and workers, particularly groups of workers represented by a union.

Industrial relations are basically the **interactions between employers, employees and the government**, and the institutions and associations through which such interactions are mediated.

Scope of IR:

1. **Labour relations**, i.e., relations between labour union and management.
2. **Employer-employee relations** i.e. relations between management and employees.
3. The role of **various parties** viz., employers, employees, and state in maintaining industrial relations.
4. The mechanism of **handling conflicts** between employers and employees, in case conflicts arise.

Objectives of IR:

1. **Improvement of** economic conditions of workers.
2. State **control over** industrial undertakings with a view to regulating production and promoting harmonious industrial relations.
3. **Socialisation and rationalisation** of industries by making the state itself a major employer.
4. Vesting of a proprietary **interest** of the workers in the industries in which they are employed.

OBJECTIVES OF INDUSTRIAL RELATIONS

- ➡ To **promote and develop** congenial labour management relations
- ➡ To **enhance the economic status of the worker** by improving wages, benefits and by helping the worker in evolving sound budget
- ➡ To **regulate the production** by minimizing industrial conflicts through state control
- ➡ To **socialize industries** by making the government as an employer

- ➡ To provide an **opportunity to the workers** to have a say in the management and decision making
- ➡ To **encourage and develop trade unions** in order to improve the workers strength
- ➡ To **avoid industrial conflicts** and their consequences
- ➡ To **extend and maintain** industrial democracy

Industrial Relations **Versus** Employee Relations

Industrial relations generally refers to the laws, duties and employer and labor union obligations in a **union work environment**.

Employee relations typically refers to laws, duties and employer obligations in a **nonunion work environment**. Industrial relations commonly **involves three parties**: the employee, employer and the union. With employee relations, **just the** employee and employer are parties to the working relationship.

FACTORS OF INDUSTRIAL RELATIONS

Institutional factors: These factors include government policy, labour legislations, voluntary courts, collective agreement, employee courts, employers federations, social institutions like community, caste, joint family, creed, system of beliefs, attitudes of works, systems of power status.

Economic factors: These factors include economic organization, like capitalist, communist mixed etc, the structure of labour force, demand for and supply of labour force.

Technological factors: These factors include mechanization, automation, rationalization, computerization

Social and cultural factors: These factors include population, religion, customs and traditions of people , ethnic groups, cultures of various groups of people

Political factors: These factors include **political system** in the country , political parties and their ideologies, their growth, mode of achievement of their policies, involvement in trade unions

Governmental factors: These factors include **governmental policies** like industrial policy, economic policy, labour policy, export policy

Role of Trade Unions in India

Trade unions are a major component of the system of modern industrial relations in any nation, each having their own set of objectives or goals to achieve according to their constitution and each having its own strategy to reach those goals.

Union of workers plays an important role in industrial system. Right to form Trade Union is a fundamental right under Article 19 (1) (c) of the Indian Constitution.

Objectives and Need of Trade Union

1. **Wages and salaries**-Wages and salaries and the most important subjects of Trade Unions. In the organized industry, wages and benefits are determined through processes such as collective bargaining, wage boards, conciliation, and adjudication. Working of all these processes deserves systematic inquiry. Union power and objective facts hopefully influence the wage scene through these forums.

2. Working conditions-Another major objective of the Trade Unions is to insure the **safety of workers**. While working every worker must be provided with basic facilities like. Drinking water, minimum working hours, paid holidays, social security, safety equipments, lights and others.

3. Personnel policies-Any personal policy of the employer with respect to promotion, transfer and training may be challenge by Trade Unions if arbitrary.

4. **Discipline**-Trade Unions also protect the workers from arbitrary discipline action taken by management against any worker.

No worker should be victimized by management in the form of arbitrary transfer or suspension.

5. Welfare-The main objective of the Trade Union is to work for the welfare of the workers. This includes **welfare of the family members or children of the worker.**

6. Employee and Employer Relations-for an industrial peace there must be **harmony between employer and employee.** But due to superior power of the management sometimes conflict arises in this situation Trade Union represent the whole group of workers and continue negotiations with management.

7. **Negotiating Machinery**-Trade Unions may also put proposals before management, as this policy is based on the principle of “Give and Take” Trade Unions protect the interest of workers through collective bargaining.

8. **Safeguarding Organisational Health and the Interest of the Industry**-Trade Unions also help in achieving employee satisfaction. Trade unions also help in better industrial relation by creating procedure to resolve the industrial dispute.

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9. **Alone workers feel weak.** Trade Union provides him a **platform to join others** to achieve social objectives.

TRADE UNION MOVEMENT IN INDIA

- ▮ The trade union movement emerged in India, basically as a reaction to the state interventionist or state pluralism model. The economic reforms' package (emphasis on privatization, liberalization and austerity measures)
- ▮ Trade Union in India is the primary instrument for promoting the union of trade union movement and championing the cause of working class in India.
- ▮ All India Trade Union Congress (AITUC)
- ▮ All India State Government Employees Federation- AISGF
- ▮ Center of Indian Trade Unions - CITU
- ▮ Hind Mazdoor Sabha - HMS
- ▮ Trade Union International - TUI



"...6 and don't forget to ask for more overtime."